Master's Programme

Speciality and specialisation

Speciality: 7008001 – Coaching

Specialisation: Theory of Sports Training (by sport)

1. General information about the programme

The master's programme in Theory of Sports Training (by sport), within the Coaching speciality at Azerbaijan Sports Academy, prepares highly qualified professionals with modern scientific knowledge and professional skills in sport.

The programme covers theoretical and methodological foundations of sports training, stages of athlete development, management of technical, tactical and physical preparation, and psychological and biological aspects of sports activity.

Particular attention is paid to professional decision-making, research, analytical skills, and the ability to plan and manage sports preparation.

Students study the scientific foundations of athletic preparation, modern diagnostic and analytical methods, training planning and assessment, and national and international competition systems.

2. Programme objective

To train highly qualified coaches and research specialists across sports who can plan, organise and manage athlete development using modern scientific approaches and international experience.

3. Key programme details

- Level: Master's degree
- Mode: Full-time
- Duration: 2 years (4 semesters)
- Total credits: 120
- Languages of instruction: Azerbaijani, Russian and English
- Annual tuition: AZN 3,000 for Azerbaijani citizens; AZN 3,500 for foreign citizens
- Classes start: 17:15
- Class frequency: 4 times per week

4. Teaching arrangements and international experience

Master's instruction is delivered full-time. Classes begin at 17:15 and are held four times a week.

The learning process combines theoretical knowledge, contemporary coaching methods, research skills and professional competencies in managing athletic preparation.

Some subjects are taught in modular format by international specialists, enabling students to engage with international research and professional experience and current theoretical and methodological approaches.

Depending on the subject and curriculum, classes may combine online lectures and in-person seminars.

5. Curriculum and programme structure

Under the annual working curriculum for the 2026/2027 academic year, the programme has four semesters of 30 credits each, totalling 120 credits.

YEAR 1 — Semester I: Autumn (15 weeks, 30 credits)

- Research Methods — 6 credits
- Professional English (Sport) — 6 credits
- Modern Theory of Sports Training — 6 credits
- Applied Sports Biomechanics — 6 credits
- Elective Block I — 6 credits: Management, Ethical Conduct and Safety in Sport; Athlete Dual-Career Development.

YEAR 1 — Semester II: Spring (30 credits)

- Academic Writing and Ethics — 6 credits
- Applied Kinesiology and Fundamentals of Human Movement — 6 credits
- Psychological Preparation in Sport — 6 credits
- Special Physical Preparation in the Selected Sport — 6 credits
- Elective Block II — 6 credits: Modern Technologies in Teaching Sports Training; Scientific and Technological Progress and Educational Technologies in Sport.

YEAR 2 — Semester III: Autumn (15 weeks, 30 credits)

- Research Analytics — 6 credits
- Technical Preparation and Motor Learning in the Selected Sport — 6 credits
- Decision-Making and Expert Approaches in the Training Process — 6 credits
- Elective Block III — 6 credits: Sports Pharmacology, Nutrition and Doping in Sport; Sport and Healthy Lifestyle; Fitness Training.
- Elective Block IV — 6 credits: Strategic Management in Sport; Athlete Dual-Career Development; Management of Mass Sport Programmes.

YEAR 2 — Semester IV: Spring (30 credits)

- Scientific and Pedagogical Internship — 6 credits
- Research Internship — 6 credits
- Master's Dissertation — 18 credits

The curriculum combines theoretical and practical subjects, electives, teaching and research placements, and preparation of the master's dissertation.

Internship duration is determined by the curriculum. In the submitted working plan, one internship week corresponds to 1.5 credits. Holidays may last 6–10 weeks under the curriculum.

6. Master's admission rules

Admission is based on the results of a two-stage entrance examination conducted under State Examination Centre (SEC) rules. It assesses logical reasoning, information technology and foreign-language knowledge.

The following minimum scores are stated for participation in the specialisation-selection/coding stage:

- Logical reasoning: at least 10 points
- Information technology: at least 5 points
- Foreign language: at least 5 points

- Overall score: at least 30 points

Meeting these thresholds permits participation in specialisation selection but does not guarantee admission. Final admission depends on examination scores, competition requirements and available places.

Applicants may use the results of examination stages in accordance with the SEC rules applicable to the relevant year.

7. Who may apply?

Graduates with bachelor's degrees in relevant specialities may apply for the master's specialisation Theory of Sports Training (by sport) within Coaching.

Eligibility should be checked against the bachelor's-to-master's specialisation compatibility table published in the SEC's 'Magistr 3' journal for the relevant year.

Applicants are advised to verify the applicable compatibility table before applying.

8. Documents required for admission and registration

Admitted applicants must first register via the designated electronic portal and upload the required documents.

During electronic registration:

- Scanned proof of bachelor's degree completion and transcript, or scanned diploma and diploma supplement.

During registration at the Academy:

- Application or prescribed questionnaire; curriculum vitae; diploma and diploma supplement.
- Copy of identity card; copy of military registration or relevant military document.
- Medical certificate; receipt for tuition payment (for fee-paying students).
- Six photographs measuring 3 × 4 cm.
- Supporting documents for tuition-fee exemption, where applicable.
- Any other documents required by the Academy.

The exact list and submission procedure are confirmed under the Academy's requirements during registration.

9. Employment and career opportunities

Graduates may work as:

- Teachers and researchers at higher education institutions and research centres.
- Coaches and head coaches in sports clubs and youth sports schools.
- Managers in sports schools and relevant sports organisations.
- Coaches in national sports federations and sports programmes.
- Specialists and head coaches on national-team coaching staffs.
- Personal coaches.
- Physical preparation coaches in fitness and wellness centres.

10. Further study

Successful graduates may explore doctoral study in pedagogy, rehabilitation medicine, sports medicine, therapeutic physical education, balneology and physiotherapy, subject to relevant admission and speciality-compatibility requirements.